

Saint Thomas of Canterbury, also known as Thomas Becket, was described as having a robust build, with a fair complexion and a prominent nose. His appearance is often depicted in medieval art, where he is shown wearing the vestments of an archbishop, including a mitre and chasuble, which reflect his high ecclesiastical status

Description of Saint Thomas of Canterbury

Various historical accounts and artistic representations provide insights into his appearance.

Physical Build — He was described as robust and strong, indicating a healthy physique.

Facial Features — Accounts suggest he had a fair complexion and a prominent nose, typical of the era.

Clothing — In art, he is often depicted in the vestments of an archbishop, including a mitre and chasuble, symbolizing his ecclesiastical authority.

Artistic Representations — Many medieval artworks portray him with a halo, emphasizing his sainthood and martyrdom.

Saint Thomas of Canterbury was described as a tall and slender figure with dark hair and a pale complexion that flushed with excitement. His physical features included a long nose and a straightly-featured face, which were noted by his contemporaries.

Description of Saint Thomas of Canterbury

Various historical accounts provide insights into his appearance.

- **Height and Build** — He was described as tall and spare.
- **Hair and Complexion** — Thomas had dark hair and a pale face.
- **Facial Features** — His features included a long nose and a straight face.
- **Emotional Expression** — His face would flush with excitement, indicating a lively character.}}

Saint Thomas Becket, also known as Thomas of Canterbury, was described as slim and pale, with dark hair and a long nose. His physical appearance was noted in historical accounts, emphasizing his delicate features and overall slender build

Physical Descriptions of Saint Thomas Becket

Various historical sources provide insights into his appearance.

Build — He was described as slim of growth and pale of hue.

Hair — Becket had dark hair, which contributed to his distinctive look.

Facial Features — His face was characterized by a long nose and straight features.

Overall Impression — Accounts suggest he had a delicate appearance, which contrasted with his strong personality.

Saint Thomas Becket: The Iconography

In Canterbury, England, the natal day of St. Thomas of Canterbury, Bishop and Martyr. For defending justice and ecclesiastical immunities, he was put to the sword by impious men in his own basilica and ascended to Heaven as a martyr. — [Roman Martyrology](#) for December 29

As Archbishop of Canterbury St. Thomas Becket engaged in a bitter dispute with Henry II over the independence of the Church. He was finally assassinated by some of Henry's knights while he was saying Mass.

Because of Becket's fame as an opponent of royal authority, Henry VIII and his Protestant heirs undertook a determined effort to suppress his cult and destroy his images. They certainly succeeded in the case of public art and liturgy in England, but a number of manuscript miniatures survived, both in England and on the

SHOWN ABOVE: Detail from [an enamel chasse](#) in the Cluny Museum, Paris.
OTHER IMAGES



continent.[1](#)

Willem Vrelant's "Martyrdom of St. Thomas Becket" (Bruges, early 1460s). (See the [description page](#).)

Most of these miniatures portray the martyrdom, usually in the manner illustrated in the picture at right: In a chasuble, Thomas says Mass facing an altar with a chalice and a small dossal, accompanied by an acolyte holding a processional cross. The assassins come

at him from behind, either striking the saint or in some examples brandishing their swords in preparation for the kill. The 12th-century image at the top of this page differs a bit from the miniatures, having no acolyte and only two assassins, but it is basically the same.

MORE IMAGES

- 12th century: Thomas is included among the bishops portrayed in the lower register of [the main apse at Monreale Cathedral](#), Sicily.
- First quarter of the 15th century: In an English manuscript of the Use of Sarum, a copy of the hymn headed by the rubric *de sancto thoma* and Thomas's half-height portrait in an initial G. He wears a mitre and pallium and holds a processional cross. A heavy dark line has been drawn across the rubric; a light X crosses out the text of the hymn. See [Gameson](#), 144.
- First half of the 15th century: The Burnet Psalter (Aberdeen University Library MS 25) has the hymn and a miniature of the martyrdom on fol. 20v-21r. It follows the usual pattern except that only two assassins are pictured and the acolyte has no cross.
- 1430-40: British Museum Harley 2900 has the *Gaude Lux Londiniarum* on [56v-57r](#), with a miniature of the assassination following the usual pattern, with one knight cleaving the saint's skull with his sword. The low altarpiece pictures the Crucifixion. The hymn has been crossed out but is still readable.
- Mid-15th century: A grisaille miniature portraying the assassination in a French manuscript, reproduced in [Gameson](#), 146, follows the usual pattern but with only two assassins, one of whom has stabbed the saint in the back with his sword.

[Gaude Lux Londoniarum](#)[2](#)

Gaude lux Londoniarum
Thoma tutor animarum
dei providencia.

Natus matre martis die.
Sequens vitam vere vie
Speciali gracia

Gaude Thoma persecutus
et per regem allocutus
eius in consilio.

Dicens veritatem pie
Pastor et hoc fuit die
Martis sine dubio

Gaude sine iure vero
primas exul rege fero
Thoma flos ecclesie.

Hoc tunc fuit die martis
Per consensum insane partis

Thomas is
wearing his
chasuble, a
chalice is on
the altar, and
the first
assassin is
striking the
saint on the
head.

Gentis regis Anglie

Gaude Thoma Martis die
vocem audiens Messie
cum esses in Francia.

"Thoma, Thoma," dixit Deus
"Sanguis tuus erit meus
Honor in ecclesia."

Sometimes the
images
accompany the
text of
the *Gaude Lux
Londoniarum*,
a hymn to St.
Thomas Becket
(see the text at
right). In the
English
manuscripts
the hymn will
have been
crossed out.

Gaude trans fretum reversus
pacis ad formam conversus
Thoma primas Anglie.

Die martis transfretasti
Tecum fidem comportasti,
Defensor ecclesie.

Gaude Thoma pastor vere
fide duce morti fere
collum subdens gladio.

Gaude Thoma nominatus
Pius martir et translatus
Villa Cantuarie.

Prepared in 2015 by
Richard
Stracke,
Emeritus
Professor of
English,
Augusta
University.
Revised 2021-
07-05.
Last
updated: 2022-
01-28.

Die martis ut vocatur
Per te multis salus datue
Summi Dei miserie.

DATES

- Feast day: December 29. The translation of his relics is celebrated on July 7.

NAMES

- Also known as St. Thomas of Canterbury, St. Thomas of London, or St. Thomas à Becket

BIOGRAPHY

- Golden Legend #11: [html](#) or [pdf](#)
- Sherry Reames, ed. "Liturgical Offices for the Cult of St. Thomas Becket" (including seven "lessons" covering Becket's life), in [Head](#), 561-593.
- Edward Grim, [The Murder of Thomas Becket](#)
- [Roman Breviary](#) (1908 English translation), I, 673.
- Carolus de Smedt et al., "Miracula S. Thomae Cantuariensis," [Analecta Bollandiana](#), XX, 427-28.

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NOTES

1 See [Gameson](#)

for several
examples as
well as a list of
English and
continental
books of hours
that refer to St.
Thomas Becket
in one way or
another.

2 Source: [Ram](#)

[é](#), 93-94.

Thomas Becket: The Imagery of an Unexpected Saint

[Stephanie Skenyon](#) 9 December 2025 9 min Read

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The Becket Casket, c. 1180–1190, [Victoria & Albert Museum](https://www.vam.ac.uk), London, UK. Detail.
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A controversial figure, no one among his contemporaries would ever have assumed that Thomas Becket, adviser to King Henry II, and later Archbishop of Canterbury, was destined for sainthood.

Born into the petty nobility around 1119, Becket received some schooling, including training in canon law. He came to the notice of King Henry II of England while in the household of Theobald of Bec, Archbishop of Canterbury (r. 1139–1161). Recommended to the post of Chancellor in 1155, Becket became a belated father-figure to the young, impressionable king.

According to John of Salisbury, Archbishop Theobald thrust Becket forward for the position because he could exert a mediating influence on Henry, who had only ascended to the [English throne](#) the year before. However, William Fitzstephen describes a much closer relationship between the king and Becket.

Recounting a famous incident involving an extravagant cloak, King Henry convinced Becket to give his new garment to a beggar they came upon in the streets of London. Without consulting Becket, the king offered the shivering beggar the cloak, nearly tearing it from the astonished chancellor's shoulders before Becket wisely gave way to the jest, walking away arm-in-arm with Henry and chuckling all the way back to the palace. The king had every reason to believe that Becket would always support him and his policies, that he would always be a close friend, and that he would consistently place Henry first.

Henry was sadly mistaken.



Nathaniel Westlake, Stained-glass window with Thomas Becket, St Peter's Church, Berkhamsted, UK.

In 1161, Becket's patron, Archbishop Theobald, died. King Henry could think of no one better suited to take his place on the prelate's throne than Thomas Becket himself. Hoping to gain firmer control over the foundations and officials of the Catholic Church in England, the king encouraged a council of noblemen and ecclesiastics to approve of Becket's promotion. Eager to please the king, the chancellor was confirmed in his new position. Thomas Becket was consecrated Archbishop of Canterbury on June 3, 1162. Henry's hopes were naturally high. They had worked so well together in the past and Becket had always given way to the king's will. What could possibly go wrong?

Many contemporaries commented on the miraculous change the appointment affected in the once worldly Thomas Becket. Becket, known for his lavish lifestyle and generous table filled with the best of dishes, quite suddenly "put on the hair shirt and the monk, crucifying his flesh along with his vices and concupiscences," according to John of Salisbury. Worst of all, he refused to support the [Constitutions of Clarendon](#), King Henry's program for the church in his realm. Convicted by a great council of contempt of royal authority, Becket fled to the Continent in 1164, remaining in exile until 1170.



Consecration of St Thomas Becket as Archbishop, second half of the 15th century, Victoria & Albert Museum, London, UK.

Thomas Becket returned to England after Pope Alexander III threatened to excommunicate King Henry and put his realm under interdict. Becket was wary, but he sailed home and was coldly received by his old friend and his court. Tempers flared again almost immediately; earlier in the year, King Henry had persuaded the Archbishop of York to crown his heir, Henry the Young King, a privilege traditionally enjoyed by the See of Canterbury.

Becket excommunicated the offending archbishop, and King Henry was beside himself. Declaring his frustration aloud before members of his court, he cried out, "Will no one rid me of this turbulent priest?" Four of King Henry's knights were eager to oblige their lord—too eager perhaps. They rode to Canterbury and, before entering the cathedral, they left their armor and weapons outside under a nearby tree. Rushing into the church,

they demanded that Becket submit to the king's will. Ever resolute, the steadfast archbishop refused. Retrieving their swords, the knights caught Becket on his way to vespers, the evening prayer service, on the stairs leading to the cathedral quire.



The Becket Casket, c. 1180–1190, [Victoria & Albert Museum](#), London, UK.

According to Edward Grim, a visiting clerk injured in the altercation, one knight struck off the crown of his head, followed quickly by a second blow. Becket stood immovable and declared his willingness to die in the service of God. The third strike was the death blow, cracking open his skull and knocking him to the ground. The fourth knight, his boot on the archbishop's neck, dashed out Becket's exposed brains on the pavement before the four men disappeared into the night.

Almost immediately, all fingers were pointed at King Henry. He loudly denied that he ever ordered the death of the archbishop, but few believed the now-humbled monarch. The monks of Christ Church in Canterbury buried their tragic father. Meanwhile, word began to spread of miracles attributed to Becket's intercession. Many proclaimed that Becket was not only a saint, but a contemporary [martyr](#).

Within three years of his death, he was canonized by Pope Alexander, and King Henry had to come to terms with the consequences. In 1174, King Henry lay prostrate in Canterbury Cathedral, performing a very public and very painful penance for Becket's death. Becket's assassins were not condemned by King Henry, but they were excommunicated by the Pope. Later, they made a pilgrimage to Rome in an attempt to seek celestial forgiveness.



Alabaster sculpture with the Martyrdom of Thomas Becket, c. 1450–1550, British Museum, London, UK.

Becket's reputation spread far and wide. Canterbury Cathedral, which soon thereafter succumbed to fire and was rebuilt on a grand scale, became the site of international pilgrimage. Churches were dedicated to him

throughout Europe and his story was told over and over again. To this day, the martyrdom of Thomas Becket remains one of the most well-known and consistently retold vignettes of the Middle Ages.

Given Thomas Becket's growing popularity, it is not surprising to find the saint depicted in a wide variety of [medieval art](#). One of the most common scenes, despite its gruesome nature, is the martyrdom of the saint with particular focus on Becket's subjection to the sword. However, although the story itself never changed and was extremely well-known, Becket's martyrdom was rendered in a wide variety of ways, each accessing particular religious symbolism for the benefit of the Christian viewer.

This enameled copper [reliquary](#) depicts Thomas Becket's martyrdom on the front, lower panel. It was made in Limoges, France, between 1190 and 1200, and likely it would have originally held relics either of or associated with the subject saint. This piece is currently in the collection of the Musée de Cluny in Paris.



Thomas Becket reliquary, c. 1190–1200, Musée de Cluny, Paris, France. Photograph by [Jastrow](#) via Wikimedia Commons (public domain).

Although Becket was reportedly attacked and killed on the quire stairs, the artist chose instead to highlight the archbishop's exalted position, celebrating mass before the altar. In addition, the famous "first strike" to the crown of the head has been reinterpreted more ritualistically as an anticipated beheading—a death perhaps more appropriate to Becket's status as a martyr.

In the Louvre reliquary, we can see the hand of God descending from the sky just above the altar. Here, Becket's martyrdom is indicated to be divinely ordained. Becket, with arm outstretched, almost grasps this holy symbol, indicating his willingness to accept his fate. Even the most famous stories were often reinterpreted in medieval art; symbolism often trumped a true retelling of spiritual events.



Thomas Becket reliquary, c. 1190-1200, Louvre, Paris, France. Detail. Photograph by [Marie-Lan Nguyen](#) via Wikimedia Commons (public domain).

The attack is more faithfully rendered in this miniature from an English psalter created in c. 1250. Psalters often contained a variety of images intended to focus the attention and spiritual energies of the faithful, and this piece is no exception. Executed on parchment in ink, paint, and gold, this piece is currently in the collection of the Walters Art Museum.

The image captures a particular moment in time, and one of special significance in the story of any Christian martyr: the spilling of blood. All four of the knights involved in Becket's assassination are depicted here, bearing down on him menacingly. Even Edward Grim, the clerk who was by Becket's side when he was attacked, is shown with the arm injury he reportedly sustained in the scuffle. Caught seconds before his death, Becket is shown with his hands folded in prayer and no sign of resistance. Again, like the reliquaries, Becket accepts his fate. However, in this case, his status as a holy martyr, blessed by his own bloodshed, is emphasized.



Psalter of Thomas Becket, c. 1250, Walters Art Museum, Baltimore, MD, USA.

Becket's popularity continued well after his death. His imagery and history remained omnipresent in the medieval imagination. Yet the imagery did transform, even if the story itself did not noticeably change. Master

Franke, a Dominican friar who ended his career in St. John's Priory in Hamburg, was responsible for the creation of a remarkable altarpiece dedicated to St. Thomas of Canterbury around 1426. Possibly influenced by French and Netherlandish contemporary style, Master Franke could hardly leave out the scene of Becket's martyrdom from his masterpiece.

Unlike many previous scenes, the martyr is front-and-center in this image, kneeling on the decorative tile, flanked by his murderers to one side and monks to the other. The knights, depicted as contemporary, 15th-century soldiers, have already dealt the crucial blow to the crown of his head. Becket's sanctified status is clearly symbolized by the prominent halo around his head, which is absent from the earlier images. However, the key difference can be seen in his face. This Thomas Becket wears an expression of dismay, of suffering, and his look implores his murderers to reconsider their mission. Where is the resolute Becket, the man serene in his suffering and accepting his death as God's will?



Master Francke, *The Martyrdom of Thomas Becket*, c. 1424, Kunsthalle, Hamburg, Germany.

Beginning in the 13th century and increasingly popular throughout the late Middle Ages, the theme of [Christ's suffering](#) in medieval art rose to prominence. This theme seeped into all aspects of Christian philosophy and experience, giving rise to what many scholars refer to as "mysticism". Stoic acceptance of God's will gave way in religious art to the physical experience of God and the tangible representation of the suffering of Christ and, by extension, his saints. Here, Thomas Becket's very visual suffering is meant to emphasize his relationship with Christ and, by extension, remind the viewer of [Christ's agonies](#) on the Cross. This piece is part of the collection of the Hamburg Kunsthalle.

There is no question that the murder of Thomas Becket captured the medieval imagination. In death, a rather unremarkable royal official and later archbishop, became a symbol of the consequences of excesses of royal

power and an indictment of the ambitions of King Henry II. In the hands of countless artists commissioned by the church, however, the depiction of Becket's martyrdom engaged with popular religious symbolism and was ultimately crafted to reflect significant aspects of medieval spirituality. The malleability of the imagery of Thomas Becket ensured that this saint's story would be told and retold, made and remade, for generations to come.

A martyr typically uses a nimbus that is often depicted as a semicircle or lunula, symbolizing their sanctity and divine favor. This representation can vary, with some martyrs portrayed with a golden nimbus, while others may have colored halos depending on the artistic tradition

Nimbus in Martyr Iconography

The nimbus serves as a significant symbol in religious art.

Definition — A nimbus is a halo or aura that signifies holiness and divine light.

Color Variations — While gold is common, martyrs may also be depicted with colored halos, such as blue or red.

Artistic Representation — In medieval art, martyrs are often shown with a lunula-shaped nimbus, enhancing their spiritual significance.

Cultural Differences — Different cultures may depict martyrs with varying styles of nimbus, reflecting local artistic traditions.

Saint Thomas of Canterbury is commonly associated with symbols such as the sword, representing his martyrdom, and the scallop shell, which signifies pilgrimage. These symbols reflect his life, particularly his role as Archbishop and his eventual martyrdom in 1170.

Common Symbols of Saint Thomas of Canterbury

Saint Thomas of Canterbury is represented by various symbols that reflect his legacy.

Sword — Represents his martyrdom; he was killed for opposing King Henry II.

Scallop Shell — A symbol of pilgrimage, often associated with those who travel to his shrine in Canterbury.

Cross — Signifies his faith and dedication to the Church, often depicted in iconography.

Pilgrim Badge — Souvenirs from his shrine, featuring diverse imagery related to his life and martyrdom.

Common prayers associated with Saint Thomas of Canterbury include the Novena to Saint Thomas Becket, which seeks courage and steadfast faith, and various prayers for protection of the Church. These prayers often emphasize themes of faith, martyrdom, and divine guidance

Common Prayers to Saint Thomas of Canterbury

Saint Thomas Becket is honored through several significant prayers.

Novena to Saint Thomas Becket — A traditional prayer for courage and protection of the Church.

Prayer for Faith — A prayer that seeks to strengthen faith and overcome doubt.

Liturgical Prayers — Specific readings and prayers used during his feast day, emphasizing gratitude and salvation.

Devotions — Various devotions encourage Christians to reflect on his life and martyrdom.



Boston Catholic Journal



NIHIL NISI IESUM

DEDICATED TO MARY, MOTHER OF GOD

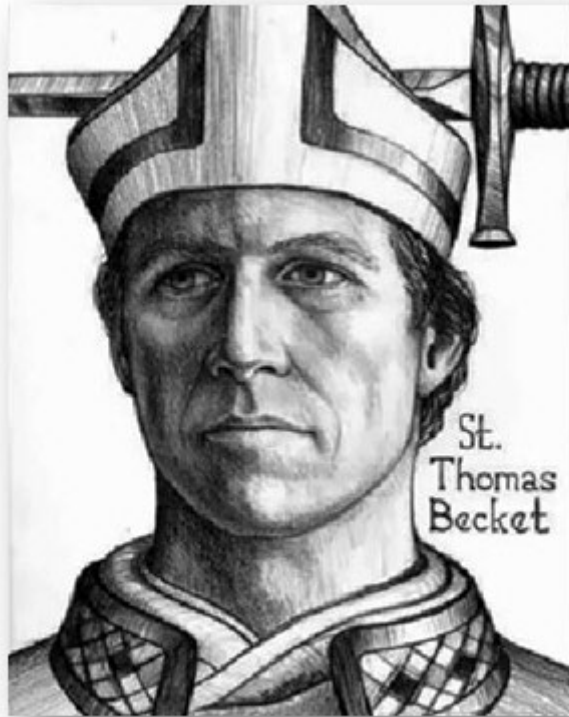
"Salus animarum Lex esto — The Salvation of Souls is the Supreme Law in the Church" (Canon Law 175)

I know that, after my departure, ravening wolves will enter in among you, not sparing the flock. And of your own selves shall arise men speaking perverse things, to draw away disciples after them. (Acts 20.29)

Prayer to Saint Thomas Becket

Martyr

Archbishop of Canterbury



“For the Name of Jesus and the protection of the Church I am ready to embrace death.”

Great Saint Thomas, Bishop, Priest, Martyr, and sacrificial lamb for the Faith, pray for us.

You who were a fearless Shepherd of the people of God, pray for us to have courage in all the circumstances of our lives, to living according to the light that your example gives to our consciences. May we be faithful unto death, as you were. May we always seek God’s Holy will in our lives.

Saint Thomas, many were brought to you for healing both in your lifetime and especially after your martyrdom, please hear and accept my prayers for:

(Names)

We pray for the living and the dead:

(Names)

confident that you who now stand before Gods Holy Throne will intercede for us and draw us closer to Christ.

St Thomas pray for us that ***in Him***, and ***With Him***, we may live and move and have our being.

Amen.

Composed by a Poor Clare Cloistered Nun



[Printable PDF Version](#)



Totally Faithful to the *Sacred Deposit of Faith* entrusted to the Holy See in Rome

“Scio opera tua ... quia modicum habes virtutem, et servasti verbum Meum, nec non negasti Nomen Meum”

“I know your works ... that you have but little power, and yet you have kept My word, and have not denied My Name.” (Apocalypse 3.8)

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Novena Begins: December 20

Feast Day: December 29

Day 1 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

Day 2 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

Day 3 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

Day 4 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

Day 5 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

Day 6 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

Day 7 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

Day 8 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

Day 9 – St. Thomas Becket Novena

Let us begin, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

O God, for the sake of whose Church the glorious Bishop St. Thomas Becket fell by the sword of ungodly men, grant, we beseech You, that all who implore his aid may obtain the good fruit of their petitions.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, Your Son, who lives and reigns with You in the unity of the Holy Spirit, God, forever and ever. Amen.

(Mention your request here...)

St. Thomas Becket, pray for us.

Pray one: Our Father...

Pray one: Hail Mary...

Pray one: Glory Be...

30 Powerful St Thomas Prayers for Faith, Doubt & Divine Encounter

March 17, 2026 by [Denis Solomon](#)

The story of **St Thomas** reminds us that even in moments of doubt, faith can be restored through a personal encounter with God. Known as “Doubting Thomas,” he moved from uncertainty to bold declaration when he

encountered the risen Christ, saying in *John 20:28*, “My Lord and my God!” This powerful moment teaches us that doubt is not the end it can be the beginning of deeper faith.

A **St Thomas prayer** is especially meaningful for those struggling with doubt, confusion, or a desire to strengthen their belief in God. It invites honesty, trust, and a deeper relationship with Christ. Just as Jesus met Thomas in his doubt, He meets us in our questions and leads us into truth.

In this post, you will find powerful, scripture-based St Thomas prayers that will help you grow in faith, overcome doubt, and experience God more deeply.

Scripture of the Day

“Then he said to Thomas, ‘Put your finger here; see my hands. Reach out your hand and put it into my side. Stop doubting and believe.’” — [John 20:27 NIV]

St Thomas Prayer for Strengthening Faith

John 20:28 – *“Thomas said to him, ‘My Lord and my God!’”*

Prayer:

Lord Jesus, like Thomas, I declare You as my Lord and my God. Strengthen my faith in You beyond what I can see or understand. Help me to trust You completely in every situation. Remove every trace of doubt from my heart. Let my belief in You grow stronger each day. I declare unshakable faith, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer to Overcome Doubt

John 20:27 – *“Stop doubting and believe.”*

Prayer:

Lord, I bring my doubts and uncertainties before You today. You know the questions in my heart and the struggles in my mind. Help me to move from doubt into strong belief. Replace my fears with confidence in Your truth. Teach me to trust even when I do not understand. I declare faith over doubt, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Deeper Belief

Hebrews 11:1 – *“Now faith is confidence in what we hope for and assurance about what we do not see.”*

Prayer:

Father, increase my faith and deepen my belief in You. Help me to trust in what I cannot see with my physical eyes. Let my confidence be rooted in Your promises. Strengthen my heart to stand firm in faith. Remove every form of unbelief from within me. I declare deeper faith and assurance, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Personal Encounter with Christ

John 14:6 – *“I am the way and the truth and the life...”*

Prayer:

Lord Jesus, I desire a deeper and personal encounter with You. Reveal Yourself to me in a fresh and powerful way. Let me know You not just by words, but by experience. Draw me closer into Your presence daily. Open my heart to receive Your truth and life. I declare a personal encounter with You, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Trust in God

Proverbs 3:5 – *“Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding.”*

Prayer:

Lord, help me to trust You with all my heart and not rely on my own understanding. Even when things are unclear, let me lean fully on You. Guide my decisions and direct my path. Remove every fear that comes from uncertainty. Teach me to depend on You completely. I declare total trust in You, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer in Times of Uncertainty

Isaiah 41:10 – *“Do not fear, for I am with you... I will strengthen you and help you.”*

Prayer:

Lord, in times of uncertainty, I choose to trust in Your presence. You have promised to be with me and to strengthen

me. Remove every fear and anxiety from my heart. Fill me with courage and assurance. Help me to stand firm in faith no matter the situation. I declare [peace](#) and confidence, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Spiritual Growth

2 Peter 3:18 – *“But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ.”*

Prayer:

Heavenly Father, help me to grow spiritually every day. Increase my knowledge of You and deepen my relationship with You. Let my faith mature and become stronger. Guide me into greater understanding of Your Word. Help me to walk in Your grace daily. I declare spiritual growth in my life, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Assurance of God's Presence

Matthew 28:20 – *“And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age.”*

Prayer:

Lord, thank You for Your promise to always be with me. Even when I feel alone, help me to remember Your presence. Let me sense Your nearness in every moment. Comfort me with the assurance that You are always there. Strengthen my heart with this truth. I declare Your presence surrounds me always, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Bold Faith

Ephesians 3:12 – *“In him and through faith in him we may approach God with freedom and confidence.”*

Prayer:

Lord, give me boldness to approach You with confidence and faith. Remove every fear that holds me back from trusting You fully. Help me to stand firm in my belief without hesitation. Let my faith be strong and courageous. Teach me to walk boldly in Your promises. I declare bold faith in my life, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Confidence in God's Promises

Joshua 21:45 – *“Not one of all the Lord's good promises to Israel failed; every one was fulfilled.”*

Prayer:

Faithful God, I thank You because Your promises never fail. Help me to trust every word You have spoken. Strengthen my confidence in Your faithfulness. Let me hold on to Your promises even in difficult times. Remind me that You always fulfill Your Word. I declare confidence in Your promises, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Seeing God's Glory

Exodus 33:18 – *“Then Moses said, ‘Now show me your glory.’”*

Prayer:

Lord, like Your servant Moses, I ask to see Your glory revealed in my life. Open my eyes to behold Your power and majesty. Let me experience Your presence in a deeper way. Remove every spiritual blindness from my heart. Reveal Yourself to me in undeniable ways. I declare that I will see Your glory, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Renewed Faith Daily

Lamentations 3:23 – *“They are new every morning; great is your faithfulness.”*

Prayer:

Faithful Father, renew my faith every single day. As Your mercies are new each morning, let my trust in You be refreshed. Remove every weariness in my spirit. Fill me with fresh confidence in Your Word. Let my faith grow stronger day by day. I declare renewed faith daily, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Faith in Difficult Situations

Romans 8:28 – *“And we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love him...”*

Prayer:

Lord, even in difficult situations, help me to trust that You are working for my good. When things seem unclear, strengthen my faith in Your plan. Remove every fear and doubt that arises in hard times. Let my heart remain anchored in Your promises. Teach me to trust You in every season. I declare faith in all circumstances, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Trusting Without Seeing

2 Corinthians 5:7 – *“For we live by faith, not by sight.”*

Prayer:

Lord, help me to walk by faith and not by sight. Even when I cannot see the outcome, teach me to trust You fully. Strengthen my confidence in Your invisible work. Remove the need for constant proof and replace it with deep trust. Let my faith rest in Your truth alone. I declare that I walk by faith, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for God’s Guidance

Psalms 32:8 – *“I will instruct you and teach you in the way you should go...”*

Prayer:

Lord, I praise You for being my guide and teacher. Direct my steps and show me the path I should follow. Remove confusion and lead me in clarity. Help me to hear Your voice and obey Your direction. Let Your guidance shape every decision I make. I declare divine direction in my life, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Inner Peace

John 14:27 – *“Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you...”*

Prayer:

Prince of Peace, fill my heart with Your calm and assurance. Remove every anxiety, worry, and fear within me. Let Your peace guard my thoughts and emotions. Even in uncertainty, help me remain at rest in You. Surround me with Your comforting presence. I declare peace in my heart, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Courage to Believe

Joshua 1:9 – *“Be strong and courageous... for the Lord your God will be with you wherever you go.”*

Prayer:

Lord, give me courage to believe in You fully. When fear tries to weaken my faith, strengthen my heart. Help me to stand firm and not give in to doubt. Remind me that You are always with me. Fill me with boldness to trust Your promises. I declare courage and faith, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Healing Doubt in the Heart

Mark 9:24 – *“I do believe; help me overcome my unbelief!”*

Prayer:

Lord, [I confess](#) that sometimes doubt fills my heart. I believe, but I ask You to help my unbelief. Heal every area where my faith is weak. Strengthen my trust in Your power and truth. Remove every seed of doubt within me. I declare faith over my heart, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Faith During Trials

James 1:3 – *“Because you know that the testing of your faith produces perseverance.”*

Prayer:

Lord, during trials and testing, help my faith to remain strong. Teach me to endure with patience and trust. Let every challenge strengthen my belief in You. Remove every fear that comes with difficulty. Help me grow through every situation. I declare perseverance in faith, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Total Surrender to God

Romans 12:1 – *“Offer your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and pleasing to God...”*

Prayer:

Lord, I surrender my life completely to You. Take control of my thoughts, actions, and desires. Help me to live a life that pleases You. Remove every resistance within me. Let my life be a reflection of Your will. I declare total surrender to You, in Jesus’ name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Spiritual Clarity

1 Corinthians 14:33 – *“For God is not a God of disorder but of peace...”*

Prayer:

Lord, bring clarity to my mind and remove every confusion. Let Your truth shine clearly in my heart. Order my thoughts according to Your will. Help me to discern what is right and pleasing to You. Fill me with peace and understanding. I declare clarity and direction, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Strength in Weak Faith

Luke 17:5 – *“The apostles said to the Lord, ‘Increase our faith!’”*

Prayer:

Lord, I ask that You increase my faith today. Where my belief is weak, strengthen me by Your Spirit. Help me to trust You more deeply. Remove every doubt that limits my faith. Let my confidence in You grow daily. I declare stronger faith in my life, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for God's Light in Darkness

Psalms 27:1 – *“The Lord is my light and my salvation whom shall I fear? The Lord is the stronghold of my life—of whom shall I be afraid?”*

Prayer:

Lord, shine Your light into every dark area of my life. Remove fear and uncertainty from my heart. Let Your presence guide me through every challenge. Be my strength and my salvation always. Help me to trust in Your light. I declare freedom from fear, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Trusting God's Timing

Ecclesiastes 3:11 – *“He has made everything beautiful in its time.”*

Prayer:

Lord, help me to trust in Your perfect timing. Even when I feel impatient, remind me that You are in control. Let me not rush ahead of Your plan. Teach me to wait with faith and hope. Strengthen my heart during the waiting season. I declare trust in Your timing, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Hope in God

Romans 15:13 – *“May the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace as you trust in him...”*

Prayer:

God of hope, fill my heart with joy and peace today. Let hope rise within me even in difficult times. Remove every discouragement and despair. Help me to trust You fully. Let my heart overflow with confidence in You. I declare hope and joy in my life, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Faith to Move Mountains

Matthew 17:20 – *“If you have faith as small as a mustard seed... nothing will be impossible for you.”*

Prayer:

Lord, increase my faith to believe for the impossible. Even with small faith, I trust in Your power. Help me to speak with confidence and boldness. Let mountains in my life be moved by Your authority. Strengthen my belief in Your ability. I declare that nothing is impossible with You, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Obedience to God

John 14:15 – *“If you love me, keep my commands.”*

Prayer:

Lord, help me to walk in obedience to Your Word. Let my love for You be shown through my actions. Give me the strength to follow Your commands. Remove every resistance within me. Let my life reflect Your will daily. I declare obedience and faithfulness, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for God's Revelation

Jeremiah 33:3 – *“Call to me and I will answer you and tell you great and unsearchable things you do not know.”*

Prayer:

Lord, I call upon You for revelation and understanding. Open my eyes to see what I do not know. Reveal Your truth clearly to me. Guide me into deeper knowledge of You. Let Your [wisdom](#) fill my heart. I declare divine revelation, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Living by Faith

Galatians 2:20 – *“The life I now live in the body, I live by faith in the Son of God...”*

Prayer:

Lord, help me to live a life of faith daily. Let my actions reflect my trust in You. Remove every reliance on my own strength. Teach me to depend fully on You. Let my life bring glory to Your name. I declare I live by faith, in Jesus' name. Amen.

St Thomas Prayer for Total Trust in Christ

Psalms 37:5 – *“Commit your way to the Lord; trust in him and he will do this.”*

Prayer:

Lord, I commit my life and plans into Your hands. Help me to trust You completely in all things. Remove every fear of the unknown. Let my heart rest in Your promises. Guide me in every step I take. I declare total trust in You, in Jesus' name. Amen.

Testimony

There was a time when a young man named Michael struggled deeply with doubt. He had grown up in church, knew the scriptures, and even served faithfully, but inside his heart, questions kept rising. “Is God really with me?” “Why can’t I feel His presence?” These thoughts made him feel guilty and distant from God.

One day, while reading about **St Thomas** in **John 20**, he realized something powerful Jesus did not reject Thomas because of his doubt. Instead, Jesus met him right where he was and invited him to believe. That truth changed everything for Michael.

Instead of hiding his doubts, he began to pray honestly: “Lord, I believe; help my unbelief” (**Mark 9:24**). Every day, he prayed simple, faith-building prayers, asking God to reveal Himself and strengthen his trust.

Slowly, his perspective changed. He began to notice God in small things answered prayers, inner peace, and guidance in decisions. His faith was no longer based on feelings but on trust in God’s Word.

Today, Michael says, “My doubt didn’t push God away it brought me closer to Him.”

This is why a **St Thomas prayer** is so powerful. It reminds us that doubt is not failure it is an opportunity for deeper faith. When you bring your doubts to God honestly, He transforms them into unshakable belief.

Frequently Asked Questions

What is a St Thomas prayer?

Q: *What does it mean to pray a St Thomas prayer?*

A: A St Thomas prayer is a prayer focused on **overcoming doubt and strengthening faith**, inspired by the apostle Thomas in **John 20:24–29**. It encourages honesty with God, asking Him to help you believe more deeply and trust Him even when you cannot see or fully understand.

Is it wrong to doubt as a Christian?

Q: *Does having doubts mean I lack faith or that I have failed God?*

A: No, doubt does not mean you have failed God. Even Thomas doubted, yet Jesus met him with compassion. Doubt becomes dangerous only when it leads you away from God. When you bring your doubts to Him in prayer, like in **Mark 9:24**, God uses it as a pathway to deeper faith.

How can I overcome doubt through prayer?

Q: *What should I do when my faith feels weak?*

A: Be honest with God and pray consistently. Use scripture-based prayers like **John 20:27** (“Stop doubting and believe”) and **Luke 17:5** (“Increase our faith”). Speak God’s Word daily, surround yourself with faith-filled teachings, and trust that God will strengthen your belief over time.

Can I pray a St Thomas prayer daily?

Q: *Is this type of prayer meant for occasional use or daily devotion?*

A: You can absolutely pray it daily. In fact, consistent prayer helps build stronger faith. Just like faith grows over time, regular St Thomas prayers will gradually transform your mindset, strengthen your trust, and deepen your relationship with God.

What if I still feel doubtful after praying?

Q: *What should I do if doubt keeps coming back?*

A: Keep praying and don’t give up. Faith is a **process**, not always an instant result. When doubt returns, go back to God again. Meditate on scriptures, speak truth over your situation, and stay consistent. Over time, your faith will grow stronger and your doubts will lose their power.

Final Encouragement

Doubt does not disqualify you from God it invites you to know Him more deeply. Just like Thomas, your journey from uncertainty to bold faith can become a powerful testimony. As you pray these **St Thomas prayers**, remember that God is patient, loving, and always willing to meet you where you are.

Keep bringing your questions, fears, and uncertainties to Him. With time, prayer, and His Word, your faith will grow stronger and more confident. What begins as doubt can transform into unshakable belief. Stay consistent, stay honest, and trust that God is working in your heart even when you don’t feel it.

CALL TO ACTION

Don’t hide your doubts **bring them to God today!** Right now, say this:

“Lord, I believe... help my unbelief!”

Make this your daily declaration and watch your faith grow stronger.

Take a few minutes each day to pray these St Thomas prayers and meditate on the scriptures.

Share this post with someone who may be struggling with doubt you could be the reason their faith is restored.

Your doubt today can become your strongest testimony tomorrow!

December 29, 2014

A PRAYER TO ST THOMAS BECKET

Born in London in 1118, St Thomas, archbishop of Canterbury, was murdered in his cathedral on 29th December 1170. A deacon when he was appointed chancellor of England, he became a close friend of King Henry II. His ordination as bishop brought an abrupt conversion of life and led him to oppose the king over Church rights. After six years’ refuge in a French monastery, he returned to his diocese, but careless words from the king inspired four knights to assassinate him. Immediately acknowledged as a martyr, he is remembered for his courage in defence of the rights of the Church.

PRAYER:

O God, who gave the Martyr Saint Thomas Becket
the courage to give up his life for the sake of justice,
grant, through his intercession,
that renouncing our life
for the sake of Christ in this world,
we may find it in heaven.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son,
who lives and reigns with you
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.
Amen.

Thomas Becket

Intercession Prayer I

Small Yellow Cross

O God, for the sake of whose Church
the glorious Bishop Thomas fell,
grant, we beseech Thee,
that all who implore his aid,
may obtain the good fruit of their petition.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ,
who lives and reigns with Thee
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
forever and ever. Amen.

Intercession Prayer II

Portrait of St Thomas Beckett

Almighty God, you granted your martyr, Thomas Becket, the grace to give his life willingly for the freedom of your Church.

By his prayers, make us willing to renounce our life in this world for Christ so that we may find it in heaven.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son, who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. Amen.

Intercession Prayer III

Father, you confirm the true faith with the crown of martyrdom.

May the prayers of St Thomas Becket give us the courage to proclaim our faith by the witness of our lives.

Through our Lord Jesus Christ, your Son, who lives and reigns with you in the unity of the Holy Spirit, one God, for ever and ever. Amen.

... St Thomas Becket, Pray for Us ...